

Nader Hotait

Sociology, Research,
and Data Science.

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WORK EXPERIENCE

DeZIM Berlin, Germany
Postdoc 2025 – Present

- DeZIM: German Center for Integration and Migration Research
- Consensus and Conflict Department
- National Monitoring of Discrimination and Racism (NaDiRa)

Humboldt University of Berlin Berlin, Germany
Postdoc 2021 – Present

- Berlin Institute for Integration and Migration Research (BIM).
- Founder and Director: [Digital Muslim Studies Lab](#)
- Project (Lead): “Media Diets and Democratic Values (MEDIVA)”.
- Project (Lead): “Radicalization Potentials on TikTok (RaPoTik)”.
- Project: “German Islam as an alternative to Islamism? (D:ISLAM)”.

Alexander von Humboldt Institute for Internet and Society (HIIG) Berlin, Germany
Fellow 2026

- Internet and Society Fellowship 2026 – Focus Area: “Democratic Change and Knowledge”
- Six-week in-person fellowship incl. collaborative research sprint on trust in expertise, AI, and democratic knowledge orders

Transformakers GmbH Berlin, Germany
Lead Data Scientist 2024

- Collecting and Analyzing Online Data on Online Communities.
- Developing evidence-based policy recommendations.

London School of Economics (LSE) London, UK
Visiting Research Student 2023

SKILLS

 R · Python · Stata · $\LaTeX$
Git · NVivo · MAXQDA
SQL · TensorFlow
 German · native
English · fluent
Arabic · native
French · proficient

ACADEMIC INTERESTS

SUBJECTS Sociology of the Internet
Extremism and Radicalization
Digital Religion
Culture and Politics
Racism and Discrimination
METHODS Computational Methods
Natural Language Processing
Surveys and Experiments
Non-probability Designs
Mixed-Methods

FREELANCE

2026 **LAKA**
Training material; Extremism
2025 **BBF e.V.**
Study report; partnership violence

- Data Science Institute
- Social Research Methods

University of Potsdam Potsdam, Germany
Research Associate 2019 – 2021

- Chair of Inequality Research and Social Stratification Analysis.

DeZIM Berlin, Germany
Freelance Researcher 2020 – 2021

- DeZIM: German Center for Integration and Migration Research.
- Project: “Spaces and possibilities of action against racism”.

Berlin Social Science Center (WZB) Berlin, Germany
Research Assistant 2018 – 2019

- Center for Civil Society Research.

University of Potsdam Potsdam, Germany
Research Assistant 2018 – 2019

- Chair of General Sociology.

2025 **Forum Islam**
Muslim community Study

2024 **CLAIM Allianz**
AMR TikTok Analysis

2022 **UFA GmbH**
Employee Survey on DEI issues

2021 **#AFROZENSUS**
Drafting an online data explorer

EDUCATION

University of Mannheim & London School of Economics Mannheim, Germany
Dr. rer. soc., Sociology and Data Science 2021 – 2025

- **Oral defense:** May 6th, 2025. **Grade:** 0.4 (German grading)
- Graduate School of Economic and Social Sciences (Mannheim)
- Data Science Institute (LSE)

University of Potsdam Potsdam, Germany
M.A., Sociology 2018 – 2020

Humboldt University of Berlin Berlin, Germany
B.A., Social Sciences 2014 – 2018

ACADEMIC MEMBERSHIP

- 2022 – 2024 **Council for European Studies (CES)**
Research Coordinator of the Radicalism and Violence research network.
- 2022 – 2023 **The Atlantic Study of Islam and Muslims (ASIM)**
Coordinator of the research cluster CVE and “Radicalization”

AWARDS AND GRANTS

- 2026 **Deutscher Studienpreis (German Thesis Award)**
Nominated for my dissertation from 859 submissions
Körber Foundation
- 2023 **Humboldt and Princeton University Strategic Partnership**
Research grant for the project “Media Diets and Democratic Values” (MEDIVA)
Funding amount: 35,488€ EUR
- 2023 **Berlin State Commission against Violence**
Research grant for the project “Radicalization Potentials on TikTok” (RaPoTik)
Funding amount: 160,000 EUR
- 2022 **Young Scholar Award**
Award by the University of Mannheim for the project “Deconstructing Radical Content on TikTok”
Funding amount: 2,000 EUR

PUBLICATIONS

- 2026 **Anti-Muslim racism, TikTok, and radicalization**
Findings from a digital field experiment with Muslim TikTok users in Germany
[BIM Research Report](#)
- 2026 **Social exclusion and radicalisation in German Muslim TikTok users**
Presenting Experimental Findings
Book Chapter in [“The Routledge International Handbook on Social Exclusion and Radicalisation”](#)
- 2025 **Beyond the hijab: Performing religious identity on TikTok**
[Social Compass](#)
- 2025 **Possibilities for action in cases of racial discrimination**
How social constellations affect reaction behavior
Book Chapter in [“Consensus and conflict in the post-migrant society”](#)
- 2024 **Exploring the Role of TikTok for Intersectionality Marginalized Groups**
The Case of Muslim Female Content Creators in Germany

- [Frontiers in Political Science 2024, 6, 1496833](#)
- 2024 **Exploring (Anti-)Radicalism on TikTok**
German Islamic Content Creators between Advocacy and Activism
[Religions 2024, 15\(10\)](#)
- 2024 **Culture, Migration, And Theology**
Types of Actors, Networks and Discourses of Anti-Muslim Racism on TikTok
[Report for the Civil Society Situation Report on Anti-Muslim Racism](#)
 CLAIM – Allianz gegen Islam- und Muslimfeindlichkeit
- 2021 **Potentials of Natural Language Processing in the Study of Radicalism.**
A Methodological Exploration on the example of Hizb ut-Tahrir affiliated Twitter accounts.
[Conference Proceedings of the Science Conference 2021](#)
 Center for Analysis and Research (German Federal Office for the Protection of the Constitution)
- 2021 **Response strategies to racism. The Importance of Contextual Factors**
for Strategies of Action in the Case of Racial Discrimination.
[DeZIM Project Report](#)

MEDIA

- 2026 **It is premature to speak of official failure**
 Interview with nd
 German, available [here](#).
- 2026 **Alleged CSD attacker. Radicalization announced in advance**
 Interview with TAZ
 German, available [here](#).
- 2026 **The AfD's Knife Crime Portal is Built on Bad Data**
 Interview with Heist
 English, available [here](#).
- 2026 **The far-right lies to you about migrant crime, again**
 Interview with The European Correspondant
 English, available [here](#).
- 2026 **War and displacement in Lebanon**
 Radio interview with SWR
- 2026 **German Muslims and Ramadan**
 TV interview with RBB Abendschau
 German, available [here](#).
- 2025 **Fact check: How fake news target Europe's Christmas markets**
 Interview with Deutsche Welle (DW)
 English, available [here](#).

- 2025 **‘Islamist’ propaganda on social media – How does it work? And what can be done about it?**
Interview with ARD (world’s largest public broadcaster)
German, Radio [here](#); Instagram [here](#).
- 2025 **‘Islamist’ tendencies in German-speaking countries**
Interview with ARD (world’s largest public broadcaster)
German, i.a. available [here](#).
- 2024 **TikTok: “Considered en vogue among extremists”**
Interview with WDR 5 Morgenecho (West German Broadcasting)
German, available [here](#).
- 2021 **“Controversy is a selling point”**
Insights into research on the dissemination of extremist content on TikTok
Interview with Ufuq.de
German, available [here](#).

HOSTED AND ORGANIZED EVENTS

(New) Media and Migration: Methods, Tools, and Applications <i>Workshop</i>	Duisburg, Germany 2026
Fragmented and Contested? Debates on Racism in Media <i>Workshop</i>	Berlin, Germany 2026
MEDIVA (Media Diets and Democratic Values) <i>Symposium</i>	Berlin, Germany 2026
AI and Migration Studies <i>Workshop</i>	Berlin, Germany 2025
Radicalization Potentials on TikTok <i>Symposium</i>	Berlin, Germany 2024
Network for Empirical-Analytical Social Research on Muslims <i>Conference</i>	Berlin, Germany 2024
“Anti-Muslim Realities” <i>Symposium</i>	Berlin, Germany 2023
“Media as a Fuel for Radicalization?” <i>Expert Talk</i>	Berlin, Germany 2023
D:Islam Webinar Series: “National Islams in ‘The West’” <i>Webinars</i>	Online 2021-2022

PRESENTATIONS AND DISCUSSIONS

HIIG

Berlin, Germany

Panel Discussion

2026

Panel: God and the machine

DeZIM-Institut

Berlin, Germany

DeZIM_talk

2026

Presentation and Panel Discussion: Young Muslims between discrimination and radicalization in the digital sphere

Sozialpädagogisches Fortbildungsinstitut Berlin-Brandenburg (SFBB)

Berlin, Germany

Conference

2026

Presentation: Radicalization on TikTok

Ministry of the Interior of North Rhine-Westphalia

Düsseldorf, Germany

Workshop

2026

Presentation and Workshop: Online radicalization between myths and reality

Ministry for Social Affairs Baden-Württemberg / LAKA

Stuttgart, Germany

Workshop

2026

Presentation and Workshop: Ultranationalism, hierarchical logics, and the fragmentation of Arabic-speaking communities

DeZIM-Institut

Berlin, Germany

Workshop

2025

Presentation: Selective resonance of racially motivated homicides in German media debates

BAG ReEx

Berlin, Germany

Symposium

2025

Presentation: From the mat to radicalization: martial arts as a gateway and intersecting factor in extremism

Media Authority Berlin-Brandenburg

Berlin, Germany

Youth Council Meeting

2025

Presentation: Political Radicalization on TikTok

Violence Prevention Network

Leipzig, Germany

Conference

2025

Keynote: Current evidence on online radicalization and its practical challenges

Universitas Diponegoro

Semarang, Indonesia

Lecture Series

2025

Lecture: AI and Digital Religion: Practices and Implications

XIII. Future Forum Islam	Frankfurt, Germany
<i>Conference</i>	2024
Workshop: Social networks and social polarization - the new media makers?	
NAFS	Berlin, Germany
<i>Conference: Network for Empirical-Analytical Social Research on Muslims</i>	2024
Presentation: Investigating TikTok's Role in Radicalizing Muslim Users in Germany	
Council for European Studies	Lyon, France
<i>Conference: 30th International Conference of Europeanists</i>	2024
<i>Panel Chairs:</i>	
Islamism and Xenophobia in Europe: Dynamics of Extremism and Feedback Effects	
Navigating the Radical Web: How the Internet Facilitates Extremism and What to Do about It	
<i>Presentations:</i>	
How Muslim TikTok Content Creators React To Islamophobia	
Radicalization Potentials on TikTok - Presenting New Findings	
Constructing Gendered Religious Identities - TikTok's Muslim Female Content Creators	
Ufuq.de	Berlin, Germany
<i>Webtalk: Anwendung von KI-Tools in der zivilgesellschaftlichen Projektarbeit</i>	2024
Presentation: Application of AI tools in Civil Society Project Work	
Federal Agency for Civic Education	Bonn, Germany
<i>MasterClass: The Field of Islamism Prevention</i>	2024
Panel Discussion: Civic education and Prevention, a Field of Tension?! - Reflecting on one's own Role in the Field of Islamism Prevention	
NAFS	Erlangen, Germany
<i>Conference: Network for Empirical-Analytical Social Research on Muslims</i>	2023
Presentation: Constructing Religious Identities TikTok's Muslim Female Content Creators	
Lower Saxony Ministry of the Interior and Sport	Hanover, Germany
<i>Conference: Lower Saxony Competence Forum for the Prevention of Islamism</i>	2023
Panel Discussion: Digital Threats - Opportunities and Challenges for the Prevention of Islamism	
MZES-DeZIM	Mannheim, Germany
<i>Workshop: Social Science Meets Digital Data: Methods of Computational Social Science</i>	2023
Presentation: Investigating radical content on TikTok - A computational approach.	
Ufuq.de	Berlin, Germany
<i>Webtalk: Kollektive Emotionen in Radikalisierungsprozessen und die Rolle von TikTok</i>	2022
Presentation: Collective emotions in radicalization processes and the role of TikTok.	
MOTRA	Wiesbaden, Germany

Conference: MOTRA-K

2022

Presentation: Potentials of radicalization on TikTok.

Council for European Studies

Lisbon, Portugal

Conference: 28th International Conference of Europeanists

2022

Panel Chair: Islamism and Xenophobia in Europe: Dynamics of Extremism and Feedback Effects.

Presentation: Narratives of Xeno- and Islamophobia in Islamist Communication

Zentrum für Analyse und Forschung

Berlin, Germany

Conference: Wissenschaftskonferenz

2021

Panel Chair: Ways into the Rabbit Hole

Presentation: Islamist strategies of radicalization